

Tobias Treppmann

Design leader who still builds — UX maturity raised with a named method, AI shipped into production

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland

2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

PROFILE

I lead design functions and I still build. The last year went into AI that runs in production — a support copilot, a fundraising system I built end to end, and prototypes engineering ships from. Before that, fifteen years of enterprise B2B — raising UX maturity at Ninox and Datameer, and stakeholder work across a 200-person matrix organization at Spreadshirt.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV; engineering is an external agency) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- AI support copilot, live in production — assistive drafting for viewer letters in the handbook's wording. A restricted-topic list sits in the system prompt, and every send decision stays human.
- AI fundraising ecosystem, built solo end to end — analysis, prompt architecture, prototype, then a production Claude skill generating follow-up content across in-app, web and video.
- Agentic engineering as a design practice — prototypes run on real APIs and the agency ships from that code. engineering ships from that code.
- Product strategy for the platform — competitive analysis against global entrants to the German market, and a differentiation strategy built on local content.
- Design system as an API, and the tooling on top of it — DTCG tokens and multi-platform sync, built without a platform team.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — ~50 people, DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Product management and design at once — owned the main platform as PM alongside all product design.
- The decision I defended through the build — inherited a €20k client-funded project scoped as a standalone add-on and reframed it into a platform capability.
- AI alt-text in production — shipped for EU accessibility compliance under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US; the company was growing) · Berlin, Germany

- Senior Leadership Team, 5 direct reports including a design lead — established design as a function co-equal with product and engineering.
- The full range of people decisions — hired two, promoted two, let two go. Coached the design lead through a difficult cross-functional relationship.
- Interim Head of Product, July to October 2023 — then hired the consultant who was subsequently brought in as Head of Product.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE — 100+ people) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team to productize the service organization. Case-by-case support became a standard catalog.
- Methodology transfer — ran design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams, as the primary stakeholder contact for the program.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years — two UX designers reporting to me. A six-hour gap, held together by cross-timezone collaboration processes I established.
- UX maturity, measurably increased — moved design from an execution function to a strategic partner and secured executive support for user research.
- Research inside institutions that make users hard to reach — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to get to analysts working inside banks and insurers. The platform operated under HIPAA compliance among other frameworks.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany

E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

SKILLS

UX Maturity and Function Leadership

Two maturity advances, each with a named method: collaborative self-assessment at Ninox, a measured increase at Datameer with executive support secured for research · Instrumental in the UX maturity transformation at Spreadshirt, across a 200+ person matrix organization · Design established as co-equal with product and engineering · UX standards and shared design-system governance

People and Performance

Senior Leadership Team member · 5 direct reports including a design lead · Hired two, promoted two, let two go · Coaching a design lead through cross-functional conflict · Team norms redesigned so the quietest contributor became one of the strongest · Hired a Head of Product into a role I was covering

Product Strategy and Executive Partnership

Product management of a platform alongside its design · Interim Head of Product · Roadmap ownership · Executive partnership on a service-to-product transformation · A product-strategy assumption reversed with user research · C-level presentation across four employers

Research Practice

Iterative useresting.com screening for personas inside regulated institutions · Research protocols and executive sponsorship secured · Dovetail as a shared insight repository · Claude over thousands of forum posts, and Teams transcription into Claude for interviews · The threshold — AI analysis above a few hundred data points, direct reading below

AI in Production

Customer-support copilot live in production · AI fundraising ecosystem built solo end to end · Human-in-the-loop by design: manually operated and embedded in nothing, so the send decision stays human · Agentic engineering with Claude Code on real APIs · Design system as an API · DTCG tokens · Style Dictionary

Enterprise, Regulated and Multi-Market

Vertical ERP across six countries · No-code business platform across DACH / UK / US · Top US / CA / UK banks and insurers · HIPAA-compliant analytics platform · GDPR plus church data-protection law · EU accessibility compliance shipped · German native, English C2